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EXHIBIT IDENTIFIER: EXHIBIT_SG_06	**VECTOR MAPPING:** Vector 0251 / 1805
DOCUMENT TITLE: Secretary of State John Quincy Adams' Foundational 'Laws of Political Gravitation' Dispatch	**HISTORICAL DATE:** 1823-04-28
PRIMARY DEPOSITORY: NARA RG 59 (Department of State)	**RECORD GROUP / ENTRY:** Diplomatic Instructions, Spain, Vol. 9; Library of Congress JQA Papers
FRE ADMISSIBILITY: FRE 803(8), FRE 803(16), FRE 902(5)	**STATUS:** AUTHENTICATED PRIMARY SOURCE

TACTICAL EVIDENTIARY SIGNIFICANCE (ARCHIVAL SENTINEL ANALYSIS):
John Quincy Adams articulates the foundational doctrine that Cuba is a natural appendage of the United States and must inevitably gravitate into the American Union.

VERBATIM PRIMARY SOURCE TRANSCRIPTION:

Department of State, Washington, April 28, 1823.

To Hugh Nelson, Minister Plenipotentiary of the United States to Spain.

Sir:

In looking forward to the probable course of events for the short period of half a century, it is scarcely possible to resist the conviction that the annexation of Cuba to our federal republic will be indispensable to the continuance and integrity of the Union itself.

It is obvious that all the territory in that direction must sooner or later be ours... There are laws of political as well as of physical gravitation; and if an apple severed by the tempest from its native tree cannot choose but fall to the ground, Cuba, forcibly disjoined from its own unnatural connection with Spain, and incapable of self-support, can gravitate only towards the North American Union, which by the same law of nature cannot cast her off from its bosom.

JOHN QUINCY ADAMS, Secretary of State.

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